

The Nail Printing Studio

Print any design onto nails in minutes — and watch them line up.

What It Is

A beauty-tech service built around a digital nail printer — a machine that prints almost any color, pattern, or photo directly onto nails in minutes instead of hours of hand-painting. You run it as a standalone nail-art studio, a kiosk, or an add-on service inside an existing salon. Customers get unique, perfect designs fast, and salons serve more people per chair.

How It Makes Money

You charge per design (or per full set) for printed nail art that takes minutes instead of an hour of skilled labor. Faster service means more clients per day at high margin, since the ink and tips cost pennies. **Standalone:** a high-throughput nail-art studio. **As a service/rental:** place machines in salons and take a per-print fee or sell the machine plus supplies. Buyers: salon owners, beauty entrepreneurs, and trend-chasing consumers.

Startup Costs

- Digital nail printer machine from Alibaba: \$800–\$3,000
- Ink cartridges, base/top coat, primer, tips: \$150–\$500
- Kiosk space or salon chair / booth rent: \$300–\$1,500/mo
- Laptop/tablet with the design software: \$0 (own) – \$400
- Branding, design library, signage: \$100–\$400
- LLC, license, insurance: \$200–\$700
- Total to launch: **\$1,200–\$5,000**

The Numbers

Consumables per full set run about **\$0.50–\$2.00** (ink, top coat, tips). A printed manicure sells for **\$25–\$60**, and the print itself takes minutes, so profit is roughly **\$23–\$58 per set** before chair time. A single machine can do **15–25 sets/day** at peak. At 18 sets/day × \$35 × 26 days = **~\$16,000/month revenue**, with consumables under \$1,000 — netting **\$8,000–\$12,000/month** after rent and labor. Selling machines+supplies to other salons adds a second income stream.

How To Start

1. Buy one nail printer from Alibaba; test print quality, durability, and software ease.
2. Build a design library — trending patterns, seasonal art, custom photo uploads.
3. Set up in a kiosk, booth, or as an add-on inside a busy existing salon.
4. Price tiers: simple color print, detailed art, and custom photo/logo nails.
5. Film fast before/after reels — the "minutes not hours" speed is the hook.
6. Train one tech so you can run two stations and double throughput.
7. Add a B2B line: sell machines + recurring ink supply to other salons.

Where To Get Customers

Instagram and TikTok are essential — nail art is one of the most-watched beauty niches; post speed and design reels constantly. List on Google Business and Booksy/Fresha for "nail art near me" bookings. Partner with existing salons to host your machine. Offer custom photo/logo nails for events, brides, and influencers to drive premium bookings.

Pro Tips

- **Sell speed and uniqueness together.** "Any design, done in minutes" beats competing on price with hand-painters.
- **Build the design library before you open.** A deep, trendy catalog (plus custom uploads) is what makes clients choose you over a basic salon.
- **Stack a B2B supply income.** Selling machines and recurring ink/tips to other salons turns one studio into a small fleet with reorder revenue.